



Gloucester Pre School & Early Years Learning Centre

March 2023 Newsletter

Welcome to our new newsletter format. Please bear with us as we learn this new technology. Your feedback would be much appreciated.

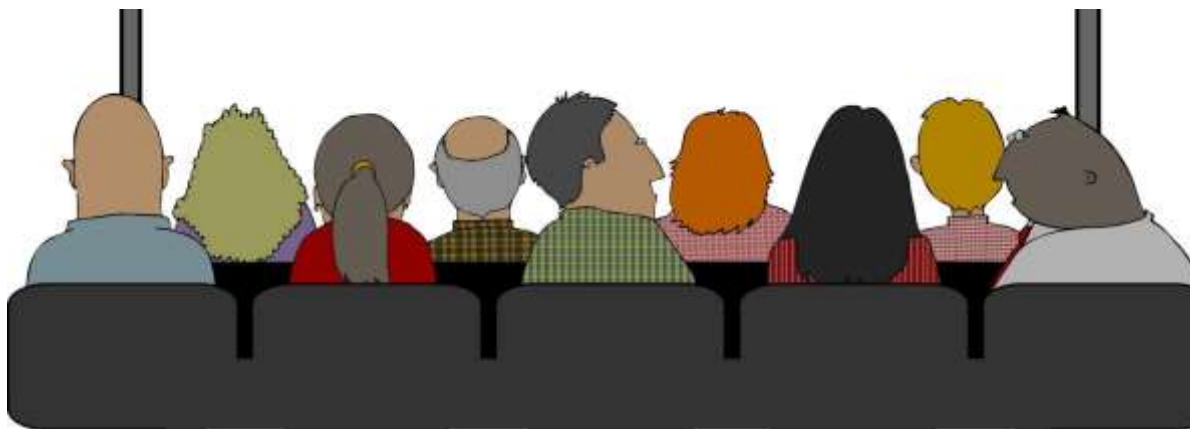
6 March 2023

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Annual General Meeting



If you are interested in joining our Management Committee, please add your name to the nomination sheet located on the front table near the sign in/out table.

AGM Date: **Thursday 30th March**

Time: **7pm to 9pm**

Location: **Dapin Preschool Classroom**

If you would like to hold a position on the committee you will need to complete the following documentation within 14 days of gaining an elected position at the AGM:

- Criminal history check (Police check)
- Working with children check – volunteer
- Declaration of fitness and propriety which includes:
 - Driver licence or other photo identification, and marriage certificate (if applicable).
- Written evidence of your management capabilities, resume or written reference or copy of qualifications.
- Confidentiality agreement

Committee members meet once a month on a day and time that suits the majority of members. This year we have met on a Tuesday evening 6pm to 7.30pm.

All positions will be declared vacant at the start of the meeting and nominations are taken for the following positions:

President, Vice President, Secretary, Treasurer, plus a minimum of 3 and a maximum of 6 ordinary members.

Role and Responsibilities of the Management Committee

As a not-for-profit (NFP) organisation we operate with the assistance of a volunteer Management Committee. The Director of the service is in charge of the day-to-day management of the service including staffing, program/curriculum development, spending that falls within the agreed budget, professional development, enrolment of children, etc.

The management committee is responsible for:

- Actively contributing to management discussions that supports positive outcomes for the organisation
- Approval of payments/expenditures.
- Approving expenditure not covered in the current budget.
- Budget development, approvals & reviews.
- Chairing meetings
- Insuring confidentiality of all records of the service whilst on the committee at all times and into the future.

- Letter writing
- Maintenance of service. i.e. organising quotes, tradespersons, etc.
- Minute taking
- Authorising pay rises and enterprise agreements that are above awards rates.
- Policy reviews & development.
- Project management when required.
- Representing the service at community engagements.
- Setting fee rates.
- Speaking at functions run by the service.
- Strategic planning.
- Support and open communication with the Director.
- Supporting the management with grievances that could not be resolved by the Director and her team. (Vice President's role).

CCSA Rural & Remote Forum



Kareen, Robyn & Elizabeth will be attending this conference on the 15th & 17th of March. We are looking forward to hearing the latest research and best practice ideas that will be presented through keynote speaks and small workshops. As well as networking & collaborating with other Early Childhood professionals.

[2023 Rural and Remote Forum - CCSA](#)

Have you been thinking about your child's language development?

Speech pathologists (or speech therapists) are qualified health professionals who diagnose and treat speech, language and communication disorders. They also work with people with swallowing difficulties to ensure they can eat and drink safely.

A speech therapist can help with delays in speech sound development, difficulties with understanding language, reading, writing, social skills, stuttering, lisps and using technology or other ways to communicate.

You can find more information about typical language development and communication milestones on Speech Pathology Australia's webpage or by following this link: [Communication Milestones \(speechpathologyaustralia.org.au\)](https://speechpathologyaustralia.org.au)

If you have any concerns regarding your child's speech, language or communication or would like to talk to a speech therapist there are several options in the Gloucester area:

- Gloucester Community Health. This is a free service in Gloucester offering assessment and recommendation for childhood language. Contact: 02 6538 5058

- Clare MacGregor Speech Pathology: Clare is a private speech therapist servicing Gloucester and surrounding areas. Contact: 0423494748 claremacgregorspeechpathology@gmail.com
- Speech Pathology Australia is the national peak body for registered speech pathologists in Australia. You can use their 'find a speech pathologist' link to search for a speech pathologist in your area, or to find a speech pathologist who can support your family using a telehealth platform. [Find a Speech Pathologist \(speechpathologyaustralia.org.au\)](https://speechpathologyaustralia.org.au)

Clare MacGregor Speech Pathology works regularly at our service supporting children's language development.

Clare is a certified practicing speech pathologist with over 10 years' experience. She has a particular interest in early childhood language development and speech sound disorders. Clare enjoys working with children in their natural environments and supporting language development through play and following a child's lead.

Clare services Gloucester and surrounding areas and can support NDIS participants as well as private clients. Although no referral is necessary to access speech therapy, Clare may suggest a GP referral to explore different funding options.

Clare is often present at Gloucester Preschool and is always open and available to listen to any questions or concerns you may have regarding your child's speech or language development.



Clare MacGregor

Policies available on website

As part of our service's ongoing reflection of current practices & procedure we have added a list of our core policies to our website. Access will initially be for primary carers only. Further access will be opened up soon. Please use your email address to login using this password: Preschool2422 (you will be prompted to set up a new password on your first login).

<http://www.gloucesterpreschool.com.au/home/policies>



Parents can download the PDFs and read relevant information. If you have any feedback or questions contact Elizabeth or Kareen.

Policies reviewed

Many of our policies & risk assessments are reviewed annually, here is a list that we have reviewed this month:

Emergency Management and Evacuation Policy

Bush Fire Policy

Emergency Management Plan

Food Prep and Storage Risk Assessment

Loose Parts Risk Assessment

Child Protection Risk Assessment

Bottle Preparation Risk Assessment

Emergency Management Plan

Gratitude Box



Behind every child who believes in themselves is an educator who believed in them first.

The committee have organised a 'gratitude box' which you may have noticed on the preschool veranda.

Parents, carers and children can write a thank you note or positive comment and post it in the box. The comments are shared with educators and staff during staff meetings. Paper and pencils can be found on top of the box. You can choose to keep your message anonymous if you wish.

The aim of the box is to pass on some joy and gratitude to staff and educators for the wonderful job they do. It is also an opportunity to let educators know when your child has particularly enjoyed an activity or said something nice about their day.

Children's Menu

Thank you to the families who completed our survey regarding the children's 2022 menu. We wanted to gather your thoughts and ideas to support our 2023 menu. It was very insightful to read your answers. There were more meals that you believed suits your child's needs or cultural expectations, which is great to hear. It was interesting that a couple of the children's favourite dishes, some of the parents didn't believe to be suited. I am pleased that there are a few parents who wish to attend the service to cook a meal with the children and I look forward to talking with you at drop off one morning this week.

Thanks again for being a part of the decisions at the service. Kareen





Recipe of the Month:

[Granny's Weet-Bix Biscuits](#) | [Australia's Best Recipes](#)

Ingredients

- 1/2 cup butter, softened
- 1 cup sugar
- 3 Weet-Bix crushed
- 1 tsp golden syrup
- 1/2 tsp bicarbonate of soda
- 1 1/2 tbs boiling water
- 1 cup self-raising flour
- 1 pinch salt
- 2 drops vanilla essence
- 1/2 cup coconut
- 125 g milk chocolate chips optional

Method

1. Beat butter and sugar, then add vanilla.
2. Melt golden syrup, add water and bicarbonate of soda, then stir into butter mix.
3. Combine flour, coconut and Weet-Bix, then mix in butter mixture. Add choc chips.
4. Place large teaspoonfuls on tray, and bake at 160C for 10-15 minutes or until golden brown. Cool on tray.



Room News

Banggu Room news

As we have had a busy start to the year the Banggu children have showed so much interest in their environment surrounding them, making lots of exciting discoveries in our gardens. We have found lots of flowers, vegetables, herbs and critters in our garden which we have been further investigating in our project book "Appreciating nature". This is displayed in the classroom if you wish to have a flick through at any time. Using our fresh produce, we have explored healthy eating habits while making some delicious butternut pumpkin chips to taste and share with others in the service. Do you have a garden at home? What are you growing? We encourage families to share any information and photos to help us extend on this great interest.



We are beginning to build our family tree, we are still waiting on some photos to display, helping to create a sense of belonging for your child in the Banggu room. The children love to look up and spot their families on the wall, feeling a sense of pride and happiness.

Please remember to keep us updated with changes to your child's routines so that we are consistently supporting your child's development.

The Banggu team - Lucy, Sharon & Liv





Yapii Room News

This term in the Yapii classroom we have focused on developing your children's self-help skills. We have promoted this learning concept throughout our daily routines and our aim is to encourage your children to be self-sufficient. When children practice self-help skills, it boosts their confidence, and they gain a positive self-esteem. Your children have embraced self-help skills by wiping tables, putting on tablecloths, sweeping floors, wiping chairs, watering the garden, feeding, and taking care of the chickens, etc. It has been exciting to watch your children develop confidence in their learning abilities.

The Yapii team - Rachelle, Leanne and Hailey-Jo



Getting to know our Team

Robyn Beggs—Bookkeeper/Clerical

I have been associated with Gloucester Preschool & Early Years Learning Centre for around 15 years. Firstly, with my children attending the mobile playgroup sessions that were held at Barrington, Stratford, and Wards River. My 3 children were then enrolled in the preschool, during which I was on the management committee for a number of years, including standing as vice-president of the organisation in 2011 and president in 2012. I have enjoyed watching the service grow over the years with only the Dapin room and EYLC yard operating when my son started. The Gawul room extension began when my daughters were attending to now the service spans over 3 blocks of land and caters for babies to 3 year olds.



I have really enjoyed my relationship with the service and feel that being involved with a not-for-profit organisation we have the communities' best interest at heart. This was re-enforced whilst celebrating our 50-year anniversary last year. The community members that pushed for the opening of a preschool in the township in 1972 were invited to walk through the service and they were amazed by the facilities that we can offer children today.

I have been employed as a bookkeeper for nearly 10 years, starting work alongside Elizabeth, Calida and Dom. My role has certainly evolved over the years and there always seems to be new challenges that roll around from COVID lockdowns to improvements in digital technology (not that long ago we manually signed children in and out using a pen and paper). After 10 years I still enjoy coming to work and building relationship with the staff, children, and parents/carers.

If you have any questions regarding your account or the Xplor App, feel free to drop by my office on a Monday to Thursday. At the end of last year, I also signed up to complete my Certificate 3 in Early Childhood and Education so you may also catch me in the room spending time with the children.

Calida Holstein—Admin Assistant



I have been working at Gloucester Pre School & Early Years Learning Centre for 10 years in the role of Admin Assistant. Mine was a new role which was created to support Elizabeth in day-to-day administration tasks as her role as Director became more challenging and busy with new policies and procedures. I have enjoyed developing the role and growing with the service as the needs have changed over the years. I love to be a part of new and improved procedures, looking to see where we can be more efficient and effective in all we do here.

My career background is in administration and hospitality. I took time off work for about 9 years to look after my two children until the youngest went to school. While I was a stay-at-home mum, I continued to develop my computer and administration skills by volunteer work at the community radio station, Bucketts Radio, which my husband was instrumental in starting. I still love to volunteer my services to the radio station and to my church.

I initially worked directly with Elizabeth, and supported other staff with technical and administrative tasks. This role has grown as I now work to support Kareen in her role as Assistant Director and I work closely with Robyn in her office, collaborating on procedures and administration tasks, and using Xplor for data entry, reporting and communication. I love formatting and editing the monthly newsletter and communicating with the pre school community via the Xplor app, email and via telephone.

Although you may not cross paths with me because I'm in the office only Monday and Friday, while I am here, I am at your service, peddling away in the background to help make sure all the i's are dotted and the t's crossed.

I have learnt a lot while working here, so learning is not just for the children but for the staff as well.

Playgroup Dates

*Gloucester CWA...Tues 7 Mar

Booral...Tues 14 Mar

Coolongolook...Wed 15 Mar

*Gloucester CWA...Tues 21 Mar

Booral...Tues 28 Mar

*Gloucester CWA...Tues 4 Apr

Coolongolook...Wed 5 Apr

*Gloucester CWA...Tues 2 May

Coolongolook...Wed 3 May

Booral...Tues 9 May

*Gloucester CWA...Tues 16 May

Coolongolook...Wed 17 May

Booral...Tues 23 May

*Gloucester CWA...Tues 6 Jun

Coolongolook...Wed 7 Jun

Booral...Tues 13 Jun

**Gloucester playgroup is available via invitation or referral only.*



Thank you for the donated items

The donated toys from Chloe and Anna



Donated climbing frame and slide from Ethan's family

Contact Us

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Visit us on the web at www.gloucesterpreschool.com.au